

ANIME

Jujutsu Kaisen

★★★★☆ | Shounen anime are a dime a dozen. Okay, calling them a dime a dozen isn't exactly fair considering some of the most popular anime of all time are shounen anime, i.e., One Piece, Naruto, Dragon Ball Z etc. But what we're getting at is that there are a lot of them, and for the most part, they all follow a very similar formula. You've either got the weak, clueless protagonist who has a lot of potential and then with lots of hardwork and the power of friendship triumphs over the seemingly overpowered enemy. The enemy is always (usually) surprised to have his ass handed to him in the end, but that's how it goes. The other variant is the secretly OP (and possibly clueless, again) protagonist who keeps his powers secret only to unveil them



when the baddies show up and again, said baddies are shocked that they got beat. That's usually how it goes, the usual tropes of funny or perverted mentor figure, the broody edgelord support character, you know the drill.

Jujutsu Kaisen has all of the above, and when you first start watching it, it feels extremely predictable, simply because it checks all the boxes we mentioned above. However, the show then pulls the carpet right out from under you by throwing curveball after curveball at you. Don't get us wrong, the show's not just doing random stuff willy nilly, Jujutsu Kaisen is intentionally shaking up the shounen formula, and it does this really well. This is a shounen that feels a lot more modern, actions have consequences, plot armor is not a thing, it's impossible for a single guy to save everyone etc. Even the way they use powers in the anime is done in a way that can't be scaled to absurd levels, which is what normally occurs in shounen anime. Nobody is going to become a God. Which we think is a good thing. Overall, Jujutsu Kaisen is a must-watch for those who are fans of the shounen genre and are looking for something that not only attempts to be different, but is.

COMIC

Guardians of the Galaxy #5-#11

★★★★☆ | The backdrop is a raging civil war between two Kree factions, the Utopians and the Imperialists, while both the factions are at war with the Skrulls. Gamora is nudging the crew (of the Bowie, not the Milano) towards become a family instead of galaxy guardians, but Star Lord and a mellowed down rocket escape on an adventure only to run into the powerful Olympian gods that have reappeared. After running into a gauntlet of gods including Artemis and Hephaestus, Zeus kills Star Lord with a black hole bomb, galvanising Gamora into fighting to protect the Galaxy again. Those were the issues 1 to 4 of the rebooted comics series, and there have been plenty of issues



since then! There were two themes in the comics till that point of time, one of role reversal, where the characteristics and traits associated with certain characters were acquired by others, and the other was exploring the motivations and sentiments of characters through mirroring, for example Groot talks

normally while others say "I am...". The theme continues into the next volumes where a dark alternative of the crew appears, assassins known as Prince of Power and Blackjack O'Hare, who can also be described as a triangle faced monkey or a trash panda. Through Nova, we find out a bit about the backstory, where the team splits into two factions while taking on an evil corporation that had weaponised the power of Galactus to make money. Rocket finds himself going along with Hercules, Moondragon, Marvel Boy and Nova. While the other group has Gamora, Groot and Drax. The story continues to take sudden, surprising and surreal twists. Through breathtaking panels, a futuristic cyberpunk palette, and action that seems to pop out of the panels, the series is building up to an ultimate confrontation with the Dark Olympians. The status quo keeps changing significantly in each issue, and through the issue, so all the characters essentially go through the process of losing everything and being remade, revealing who they really are in the process.